

July 14, 2026 07:23 AM GMT

China Steel Exports | Europe

June - flat sequentially, still lower on the year

China's June finished-steel net exports were flat MoM day-adjusted, annualising at ~119mtpa, but remain ~5% lower YoY YtD. Europe is increasingly insulated as imports are constrained, regional HRC premiums widen and CBAM/safeguards reinforce price floors and EBITDA/t upside.

Flat sequentially, but still lower YoY. China's June finished-steel net exports were flat MoM on a day-adjusted basis, implying an annualised run-rate of ~119mtpa, above our China Materials analyst's 2026 forecast of ~110mt. However, YtD, exports remain ~5% lower YoY, likely underpinned by a combination of growing trade protectionism, as well as China's new export likenesses system to control exports. Domestic production also remains muted, YtD CISA member output is down ~6% YoY, with the latest late-June datapoint pointing to a further 5% decline YoY, heading into the weaker summer season.

In Europe, policy is incrementally constraining imports. CBAM implementation from 1 January 2026 and safeguard tightening from 1 July continue to strengthen local pricing power. Although China accounts directly for only ~11% of Europe's imports YtD, the proposed melted-and-poured clause could materially extend the framework's reach through intermediary countries. Even without a demand recovery, we estimate the measures could leave Europe structurally short by 10-15mt, tightening supply and supporting higher clearing prices. Early evidence is consistent with this view: Kallanish reported last week that ArcelorMittal has raised European coil offers by €50/t, taking HRC to €770/t base delivered, with September order books reportedly full and lead times moving into October (see [here](#)) - in spite of the soft demand environment. EU HRC spreads have risen to US\$426/t, above the long-run average of US\$320/t, suggesting that the tighter policy regime is beginning to translate into improved mill pricing power.

We remain constructive, ArcelorMittal preferred play. In Europe, the steel profit pool appears to be migrating back toward domestic mills, with higher import parity, a more robust policy framework, improving utilisation and firmer order intake supporting an EBITDA/t re-base. We continue to prefer European carbon steel equities with local integrated assets, shipment flexibility and leverage to widening regional premia. **ArcelorMittal** remains our preferred play on the dynamic, offering the greater scope to flex volumes, improve fixed-cost absorption and capture share as marginal tonnes are redirected toward domestic supply. The latest €50/t price hike implies ~US\$1.7bn of annualised gross EBITDA upside before timing, mix, cost and realisation offsets, equivalent to ~17% of 2027 Visible Alpha consensus EBITDA. If sustained, the increase would support upside risk to 4Q26 run-rate EBITDA and 2027 estimates, while reducing 2027 EV/EBITDA from 5.6x to around 4.8x on a commensurate ASP uplift. We also see **Salzgitter** as a key beneficiary, with the

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EMEA - METALS & MINING

Europe

Industry View

In-Line

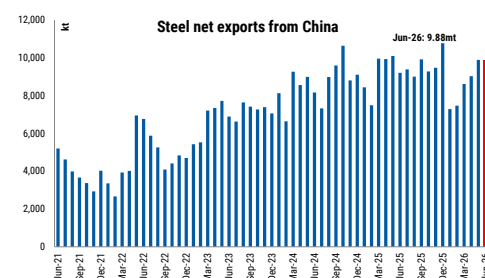
CARBON STEEL

Europe

Industry View

In-Line

Exhibit 1 : China's finished steel net exports were flat MoM (day-adjusted) in June



Source: CEIC, Morgan Stanley Research.

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earnings inflection increasingly visible. See: [Earnings Inflect, Leverage Peaks – Overweight \(1 Jun 2026\)](#)

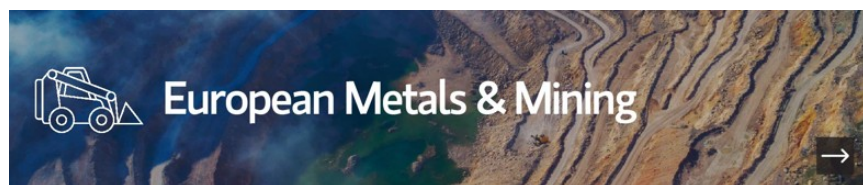


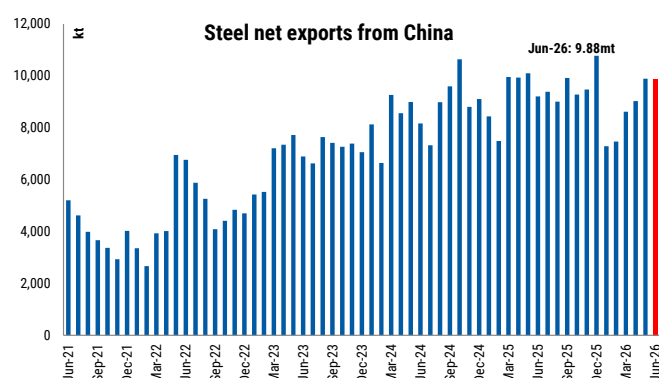
Chart gallery: key trade data

Exhibit 2: China steel trade data

	China Trade Data					
	Gross Exports (kt)	Gross Imports (kt)	Data (kt)	MoM, %	YoY, %	YTD, %
Jun-26	10,320	441	9,879	0%	7%	-5%
May-26	10,341	451	9,890	10%	-2%	-8%
Apr-26	9,500	470	9,030	5%	-9%	-10%
Mar-26	9,130	510	8,620	15%	-13%	-10%
Feb-26	7,840	370	7,470	2%	0%	-7%
Jan-26	7,750	460	7,290	-32%	-14%	-14%
Dec-25	11,300	520	10,780	14%	18%	8%
Nov-25	9,980	500	9,480	2%	8%	7%
Oct-25	9,780	500	9,280	-6%	-13%	7%
Sep-25	10,470	550	9,920	10%	3%	10%
Aug-25	9,510	500	9,010	-4%	0%	11%
Jul-25	9,840	450	9,390	2%	28%	13%
Jun-25	9,680	470	9,210	-9%	13%	11%
May-25	10,580	480	10,100	2%	12%	10%
Apr-25	10,460	520	9,940	0%	16%	10%
Mar-25	10,460	500	9,960	33%	7%	8%
Feb-25	8,040	550	7,490	-11%	13%	8%
Jan-25	8,940	500	8,440	-7%	4%	4%
Dec-24	9,730	620	9,110	3%	29%	25%
Nov-24	9,280	470	8,810	-17%	19%	24%
Oct-24	11,180	540	10,640	11%	46%	25%
Sep-24	10,150	550	9,600	7%	29%	22%
Aug-24	9,500	510	8,990	23%	18%	21%
Jul-24	7,830	500	7,330	-10%	11%	22%
Jun-24	8,740	570	8,170	-9%	18%	24%

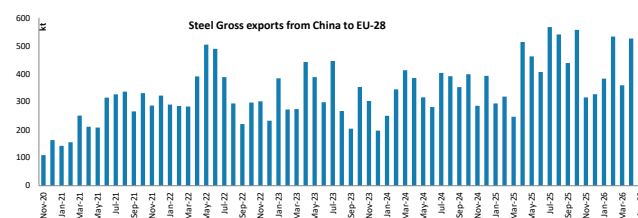
Source: CEIC. MoM = Month on month, YoY = Year on year, YTD = Year to date, N/A = not applicable.

Exhibit 3: China finished steel net exports

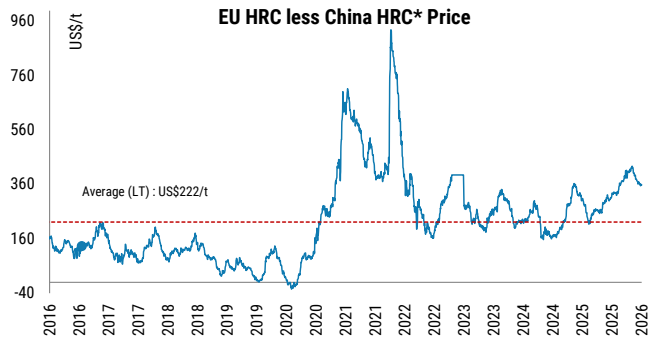


Source: CEIC, Morgan Stanley Research

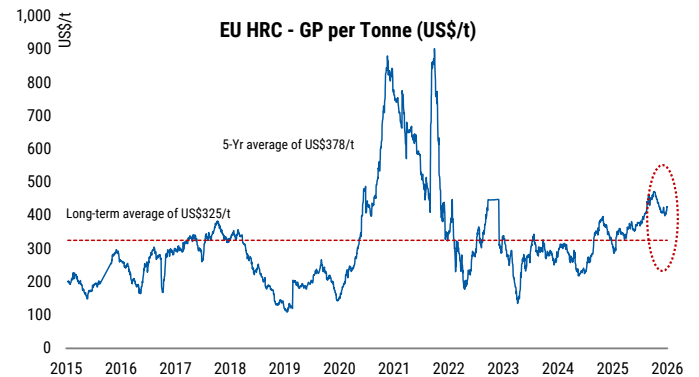
Exhibit 4: China finished steel gross exports to EU28



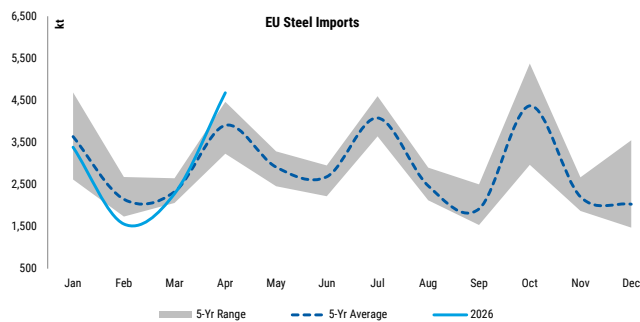
Source: CEIC, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit5: Price spreads: EU HRC less China HRC

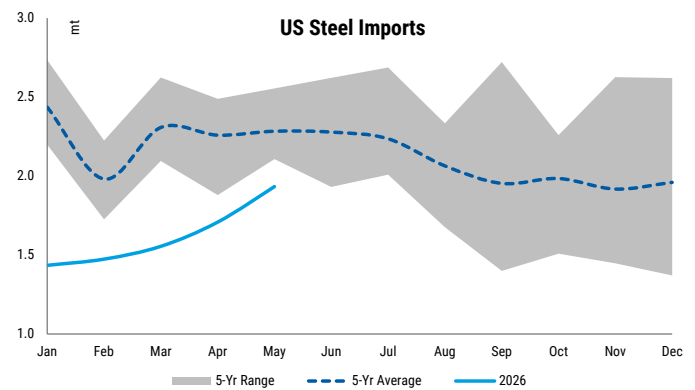
Source: Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research. * China domestic prices are based on the Shanghai benchmark for HRC excluding 17% VAT.

Exhibit6: Spreads: EU HRC gross profit per tonne*

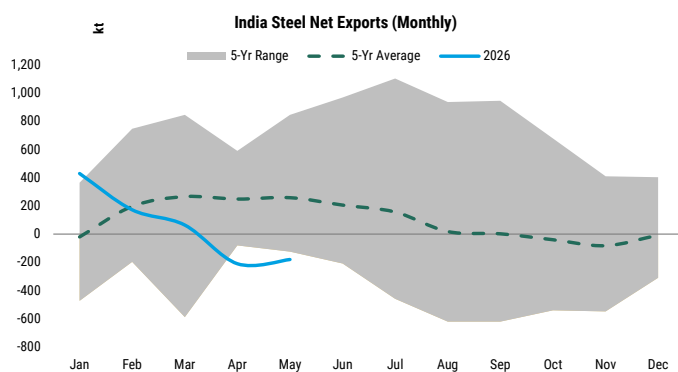
Source: Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research. * Gross profit per tonne is calculated based on EU HRC prices less the prices of iron ore and coking coal.

Exhibit 7: Monthly steel imports to EU from all destinations

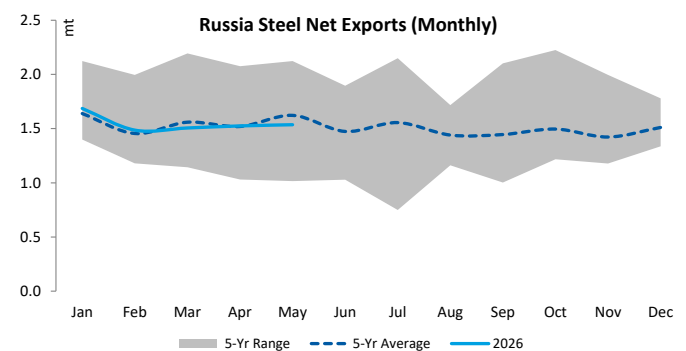
Source: Eurofer, Eurostat, Morgan Stanley Research. Note: There is a discrepancy between data sourced from CEIC and Eurofer.

Exhibit 8: Monthly steel imports to US from all destinations

Source: US DOC, Morgan Stanley Research

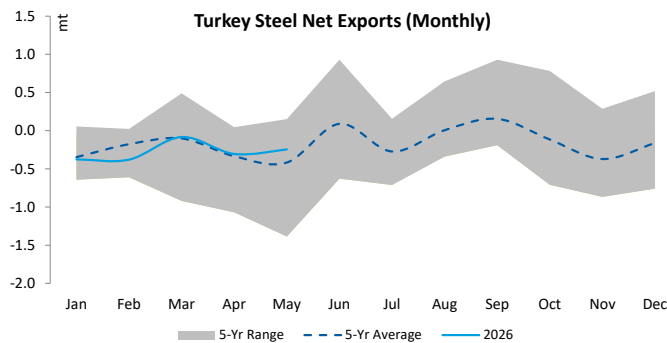
Exhibit 9: India's monthly steel imports/exports

Source: Joint Plant Committee, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 10: Russia's monthly steel imports/exports

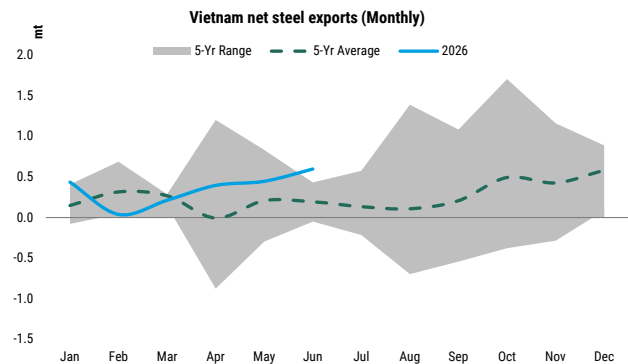
Source: Metal Expert, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 11: Turkey's monthly steel imports/exports



Source: Metal Expert, Morgan Stanley Research

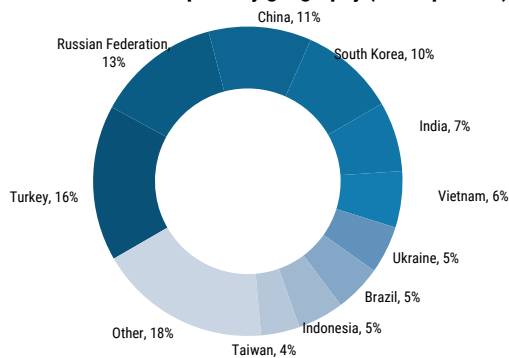
Exhibit 12: Vietnam's monthly steel imports/exports



Source: Metal Expert, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 13: EU total steel imports by geography – Turkey, S. Korea, China and Vietnam dominate

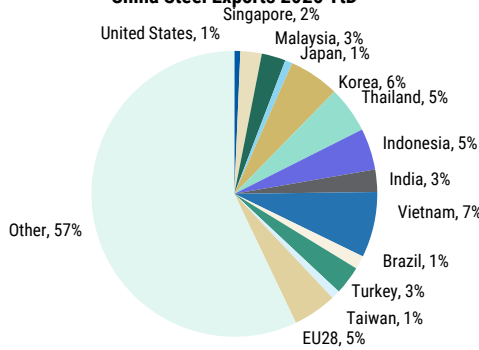
EU total steel imports by geography (YTD Apr 2026)



Source: Eurofer, Eurostat, Morgan Stanley Research

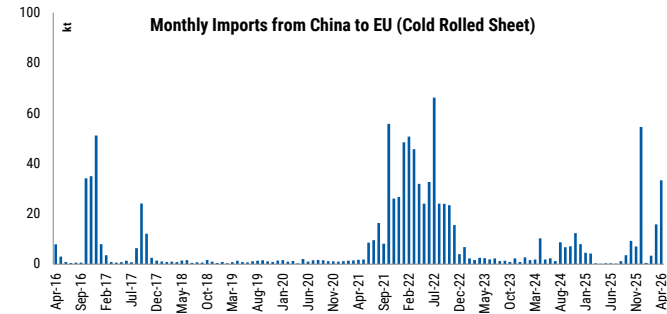
Exhibit 14: China's steel exports by geography, showing significant fragmentation of recipients

China Steel Exports 2026 YtD



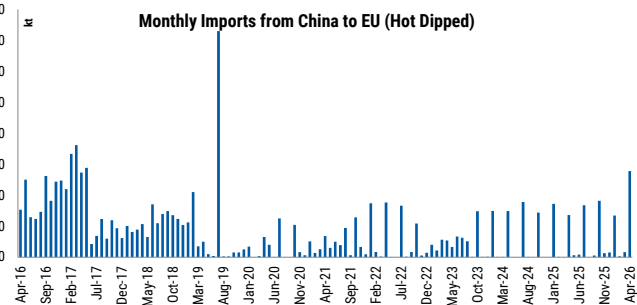
Source: CEIC

Exhibit 15: EU imports from China (cold rolled sheet) – sharp declines following AD



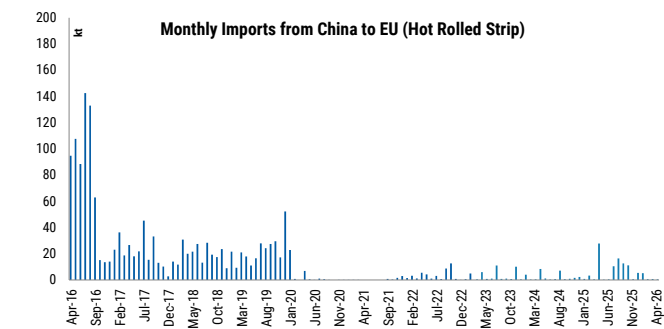
Source: Eurofer, Eurostat, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 16: EU imports from China (hot dipped) – at low level



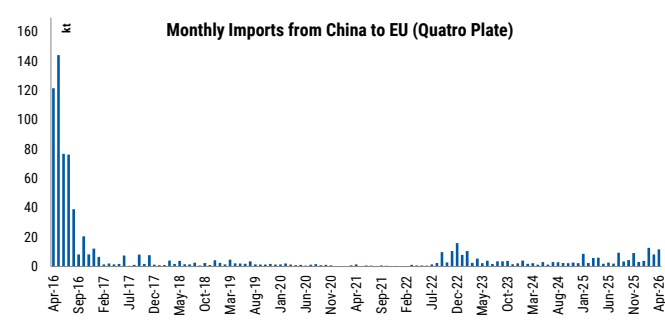
Source: Eurofer, Eurostat, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 17: EU imports from China (hot rolled wide strip) – impact of AD driving lower



Source: Eurofer, Eurostat, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 18: EU imports from China (quarto plate) – impact of AD driving lower



Source: Eurofer, Eurostat, Morgan Stanley Research

EU Safeguard Quotas & Balances

Exhibit 19: Quarterly Quotas

Product	01-Apr-2026 to 30-Jun-2026			
	Quota ^ kt	B/F ^^ kt	Imports kt	Utilised %
Carbon Steel				
Non Alloy and Other Alloy Hot Rolled Sheets and Strips				
Turkey	398	0	398	100%
India	225	0	225	100%
South Korea	161	0	161	100%
United Kingdom	139	0	15	11%
Serbia	143	0	71	50%
Others	858	0	512	60%
Non Alloy and Other Alloy Cold Rolled Sheets				
India	163	0	8	5%
Korea	95	0	94	100%
United Kingdom	88	0	1	1%
Serbia	41	0	18	43%
Others	335	0	96	29%
Metallic Coated Sheets				
Korea	38	179	216	100%
India	54	134	42	22%
United Kingdom	35	89	32	26%
China	128	0	128	100%
Others	473	108	531	92%
Non Alloy and Other Alloy Quarto Plates				
Ukraine	254	0	0	0%
United Kingdom	5	0	0	0%
Others	551	0	402	73%
Stainless Steel				
Stainless Hot Rolled Sheets and Strips				
Others	110	72	48	26%
Stainless Cold Rolled Sheets and Strips				
Korea	50	40	45	51%
Taiwan	46	27	26	35%
India	31	60	10	11%
USA	25	71	1	1%
Turkey	21	7	23	82%
Others	53	16	29	41%

Source: European Commission, Morgan Stanley Research. ^ Updated from Annex IV.1 Volumes of tariff-rate quotas, ^^ Unused quotas from previous period brought forward.

Valuation Methodology and Risks

ArcelorMittal SA (MT.AS)

In line with the other carbon steel equities, we apply a through-the-cycle multiple on 2027-2028 average EBITDA, which captures the first period in which the new, stronger European trade policy regime is fully reflected in industry economics. We apply a multiple of 7.1x, which is the stock's own historical average.

Risks to Upside

- Strong China steel demand or a supply reform programme leading to lower exports.
- A faster end market demand improvement in key markets.
- A larger buyback programme.

Risks to Downside

- Weaker steel demand in China, boosting exports and pressuring seaborne prices.
- Escalating trade friction leading to weaker demand
- Renewed end-market weakness and contracting steel spreads
- Unexpected (sizeable) investments in new regions

Salzgitter AG (SZGG.DE)

In line with the other carbon steel equities, we apply a through-the-cycle multiple on estimated average EBITDA over 2027-28, which captures the first period in which the new, stronger European trade policy regime is fully reflected in industry economics. We apply a multiple of 7.0x, which is the stock's own historical average.

Risks to Upside

- Further re-rating in Aurubis shares and a higher earnings profile going forward
- The full margin upside from the new EU policy framework, driving further EBITDA upgrades
- Successful restructuring of the HKM asset, driving upside to earnings estimates

Risks to Downside

- A de-rating of Aurubis shares
- Worse than expected demand environment in Europe
- Spending slippage at SALCOS Phases 1/2/3

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(as of June 30, 2026)

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buy recommendation; we correspond Equal-weight and Not-Rated to hold and Underweight to sell recommendations, respectively.

Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1544	42%	453	49%	29%	757	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1577	43%	390	42%	25%	769	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	544	15%	89	10%	16%	204	12%
Total	3,668		933			1731	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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Overweight (O). The stock's total return is expected to exceed the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Equal-weight (E). The stock's total return is expected to be in line with the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Not-Rated (NR). Currently the analyst does not have adequate conviction about the stock's total return relative to the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Underweight (U). The stock's total return is expected to be below the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Unless otherwise specified, the time frame for price targets included in Morgan Stanley Research is 12 to 18 months.

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Attractive (A): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be attractive vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

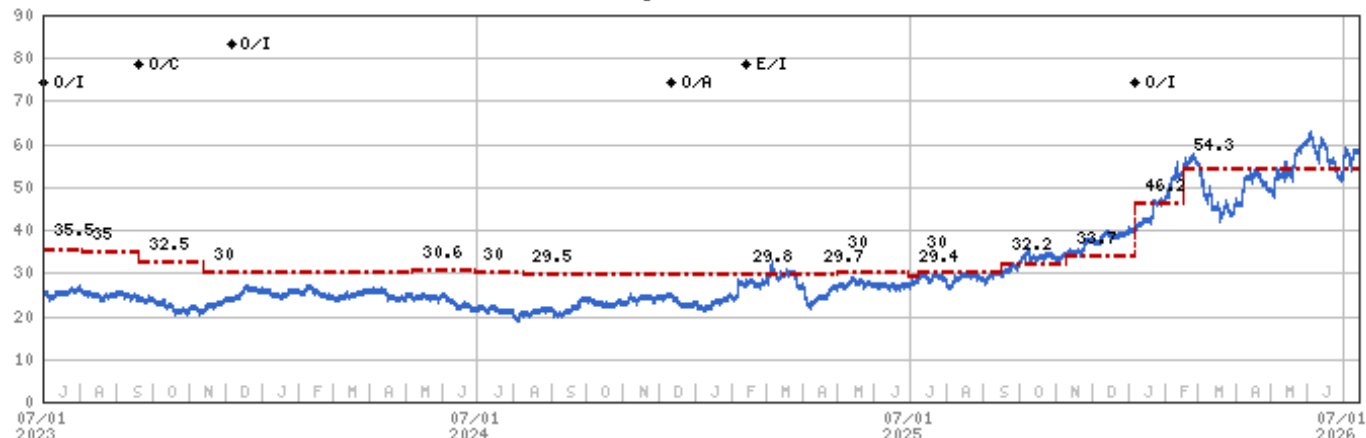
In-Line (I): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be in line with the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

Cautious (C): The analyst views the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months with caution vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

Benchmarks for each region are as follows: North America - S&P 500; Latin America - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI Latin America Index; Europe - MSCI Europe; Japan - TOPIX; Asia - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

Stock Price, Price Target and Rating History (See Rating Definitions)

ArcelorMittal SA (MT.AS) - As of 07/14/26 GMT in EUR
Industry : Carbon Steel



Stock Rating History: 7/1/21 : O/I; 9/20/21 : O/C; 12/6/23 : O/I; 12/11/24 : O/A; 2/13/25 : E/I; 1/6/26 : O/I

Price Target History: 6/22/21 : 34.2; 7/8/21 : 35.9; 8/3/21 : 38; 9/28/21 : 39; 11/29/21 : 40; 12/8/21 : 41; 2/21/22 : 43; 3/23/22 : 46; 6/22/22 : 46.1; 8/3/22 : 45; 9/14/22 : 40; 11/14/22 : 38; 3/29/23 : 37.5; 4/14/23 : 36.5; 5/12/23 : 35.5; 6/2/23 : 35; 9/20/23 : 32.5; 11/13/23 : 30; 5/7/24 : 30.6; 6/28/24 : 30; 8/8/24 : 29.5; 2/10/25 : 29.8; 4/11/25 : 29.7; 5/1/25 : 30; 6/30/25 : 29.4; 7/7/25 : 30; 9/16/25 : 32.2; 11/10/25 : 33.7; 1/6/26 : 46.2; 2/16/26 : 54.3

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)

Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —

Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View

Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)

Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

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Effective January 13, 2014, the industry view benchmarks for Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific are as follows: relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

Salzgitter AG (SZGG.DE) - As of 07/14/26 GMT in EUR
Industry : Carbon Steel



Stock Rating History: 7/1/21 : E/I; 12/8/21 : U/I; 6/22/22 : E/I; 3/29/23 : U/I; 9/20/23 : U/C; 12/6/23 : U/I; 12/11/24 : U/A; 2/13/25 : U/I; 3/23/26 : E/I; 6/1/26 : O/I

Price Target History: 6/22/21 : 28.5; 8/13/21 : 31; 9/28/21 : 31.2; 11/2/21 : 32; 12/8/21 : 30.7; 1/18/22 : 30.1; 2/18/22 : 31.9; 3/23/22 : 41.5; 4/10/22 : 43; 5/29/22 : 46; 6/22/22 : 40.8; 7/7/22 : 38.5; 9/14/22 : 33.3; 10/4/22 : 30.5; 11/25/22 : 31.5; 12/7/22 : 32.9; 1/16/23 : 34; 3/29/23 : 34.6; 5/11/23 : 32.6; 6/21/23 : 33.4; 7/26/23 : 30.5; 8/17/23 : 28; 8/31/23 : 26; 9/20/23 : 23.5; 11/7/23 : 22.6; 11/15/23 : 23; 12/6/23 : 24; 3/27/24 : 20.7; 5/14/24 : 20; 6/20/24 : 17.9; 6/28/24 : 17.4; 7/23/24 : 16; 8/6/24 : 14.9; 8/14/24 : 14.5; 9/18/24 : 13.5; 11/4/24 : 13; 11/18/24 : 12.8; 12/11/24 : 13; 3/10/25 : 15.4; 3/25/25 : 16; 7/21/25 : 15.6; 9/16/25 : 17.9; 11/14/25 : 20.5; 1/6/26 : 38.7; 2/26/26 : 46.7; 3/23/26 : 42.2; 4/8/26 : 45.5; 6/1/26 : 70.8; 6/28/26 : 67.5

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —
Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View
Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)
Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: EEMEA - Metals & Mining

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (07/13/2026)
Alain Gabriel, CFA		
Anglo American (AGLJ.J)	++	ZAc 78,780
Erdemir (EREGL.IS)	U (09/14/2022)	TL 40.86
Brian Morgan		
African Rainbow Minerals (ARIJ.J)	E (04/08/2025)	ZAc 17,264
Exxaro Resources Limited (EXXJ.J)	O (04/08/2025)	ZAc 19,465
Implats Limited (IMPJ.J)	O (01/23/2026)	ZAc 18,260
Kumba Iron Ore (KIOJ.J)	E (10/07/2025)	ZAc 28,107
Northam Platinum Limited (NPHJ.J)	U (03/20/2026)	ZAc 23,679
Sibanye-Stillwater (SSWJ.J)	E (01/23/2026)	ZAc 3,445
Thungela Resources Ltd (TGAJ.J)	U (09/11/2025)	ZAc 9,679
Valterra Platinum Limited (VALJ.J)	E (05/30/2025)	ZAc 108,221
Christopher Nicholson		
AngloGold Ashanti Ltd (ANGJ.J)	E (10/18/2023)	ZAc 131,535
Gold Fields Limited (GFIJ.J)	E (04/16/2026)	ZAc 55,494
Harmony Gold Mining Company Ltd (HARJ.J)	O (04/16/2026)	ZAc 24,802

Stock Ratings are subject to change. Please see latest research for each company.

* Historical prices are not split adjusted.

INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Carbon Steel

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (07/13/2026)
Alain Gabriel, CFA		
ArcelorMittal SA (MT.AS)	O (01/06/2026)	€58.04
Salzgitter AG (SZGG.DE)	O (06/01/2026)	€51.40
SSAB AB (SSABa.ST)	O (05/05/2026)	SKr 98.60
thyssenkrupp AG (TKAG.DE)	E (03/23/2026)	€11.68

voestalpine AG (VOES.VI)	E (06/01/2026)	€43.76
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